



No Taxi For Sure

After acquiring TFS last year, reports suggest that Ola will be shutting it down. <http://dgit.in/NoTFSre>



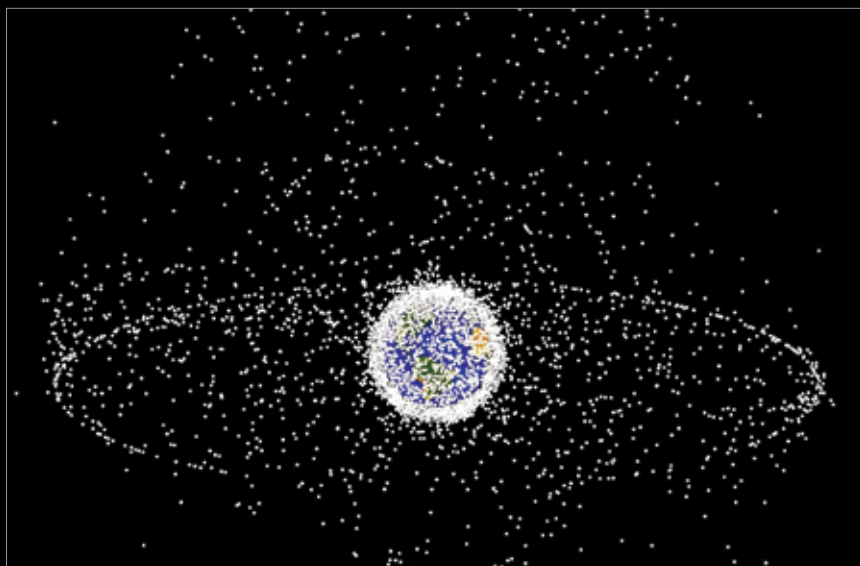
Google Maps update

Now you can restrict Google Maps to use only Wi-Fi and download offline maps onto the SD card. <http://dgit.in/MapsWifi>

Earth has a power of a few hundred thousand Gauss. Magnetars have a magnetic field of the order of a trillion Gauss. That's one trillion times the Earth's magnetic field. Magnetars are so powerful that simply passing by one from a distance of a thousand odd kilometers would result in breakage of every chemical bond that exists in our body. Basically, if even one magnetar flew by the vicinity of Earth not only would every hard disk and credit card in the world would be erased, but every human being would be ripped to shreds and all atomic matter would be separated. That's pretty macabre for a space object that has a name that sounds like a Pokémon.

04 The amount of space junk orbiting the Earth weighs almost 16 times the International Space station!

The movie Gravity depicted an incident wherein a piece of space junk wrecked havoc with another Space mission. Although, the movie was fictional the problem is very real. Over the years, on account of the number of space missions carried out by countries, our immediate outer space has become littered with space junk. Estimates peg the total mass to be close to 6,300 tonnes (The ISS weighs around 400 tonnes). A scenario imagined by Donald Kessler in the 1970s shows a vast ring of dense space junk around the earth, rendering further space flight impossible. A small accident could lead to a catastrophic cascading event leading to the generation of even more miniature junk adding to the existing sphere of junk. This runaway cascade event dubbed Kessler Syndrome could really take place, given how the amount of space junk generated has exponentially risen over the years. Not only does space junk pose a risk for future missions, but present danger for current satellites as well. Due to the high amount of velocity gained, even a small piece of junk, a mere millimetre in length, could have devastating consequences upon impact. Space agencies around the world including ESA and NASA have recognised the problem and pilot projects have sprung up.



A computer generated image of space junk as seen from High Earth orbit

05 Next time you tell someone they're living in a bubble, remember, so are you

While the many worlds theory and multiverse theory have been hot topics for discussion in literature and science for a long time, the idea that our universe is simply one bubble among a collection of other bubble universes is still radical to say the least. Why do all physical laws in our universe line up so neatly? Why do all forces in the universe get together to support life? If we consider that our's is one of many universes that could have laws with different physical constants of their own, then the above questions can be answered by simply stating the rules of probability. This is why physicists like to consider the multiverse theory. Back in 2010, a group of researchers found some irregular patterns when they were studying maps of Cosmic Background Radiation (CMBR). CMBR is the leftover relic radiation from the Big Bang event that kickstarted the formation of our universe. The researchers hypothesise that these patterns may be marks caused when another bubble universe brushed against ours. While the results haven't shown the high degree of statistical certainty imposed by physics, it is a promising direction of research. If indeed we are able to detect bruises from universe collision events, it will lay credence to plenty of theories, and lead to a myriad

more. It might finally confirm that we are literally living in a bubble.

06 Pluto the icy barren wasteland has a liquid ocean! Bam!

When it comes to its place in our Solar System, Pluto has had a tumultuous history. It was bumped off as a planet and then reinstated again. It is even named after the God of the Underworld, such is the image that Pluto evokes in our heads - a world that is barren, inert, forced to complete inactivity. Not true! We rejoiced when NASA's New Horizons made its flyby past Pluto and when the first scientific data came pouring in it was surprising to say the least. Scientists claim that Pluto has an active geography, and features on its surface

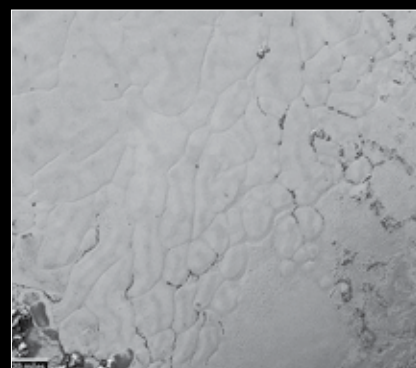


Photo of Sputnik Planum on Pluto showing hexagonal cell structures resulting from convection.

SOURCE: [HTTPS://COMMONS.WIKIMEDIA.ORG](https://commons.wikimedia.org)

SOURCE: [HTTPS://COMMONS.WIKIMEDIA.ORG](https://commons.wikimedia.org)